AI LEADERSHIP PLAYBOOK

Thank You for Exploring This Playbook

You've taken the first step toward AI leadership. Now it's time to put these insights into action.

Printable Action Items for AI Adoption & Success

Your essential roadmap for implementing AI with confidence and clarity. Download this quick-reference guide to keep the key takeaways at your fingertips.

- ✓ Quick-reference format for easy implementation
- ✓ Actionable steps you can start using today
- ✓ Key takeaways from all six chapters

Key Takeaways

AI Leadership Playbook — Pillar 1: Foundations

Chapter 1: Making AI Simple and Approachable
AI isn't about replacing your team or overhauling your business overnight. It's about taking practical steps to simplify operations, drive innovation, and grow your value with the team you already have.
AI works in two key ways: Assistance (conversational AI like Copilot) and Automation (AI Agents handling routine tasks).

Chapter 2: Activate Your AI Leadership Team
As your first act in adopting AI, set out a specific leadership team with defined roles to lead your company on the journey to successful AI adoption.
Key roles include: Executive Sponsor, AI Lead, Change Champion, and Governance Owner. Start small—even 2-3 people can drive meaningful progress.

Chapter 3: Three Initial AI Decisions
Focus on leveraging the AI capabilities within the platforms you already trust. Define your business intent, choose the right platforms, and establish governance from the start.
Ask: What business problems will AI solve? Start with efficiency, consistency, proactivity, professionalism, and personalization.

Chapter 4: Create Your AI Governance Policy
AI governance is an extension of existing governance, applied based on where AI is located and its business impact. Focus on governing the decisions AI influences and mitigate risk by leaning on trusted vendors.
Risk levels vary: Low (embedded SaaS AI), Medium (data/analytics AI), High (custom LLM/agents). Scale governance accordingly.

Chapter 5: Education & Enablement
Education & enablement are the foundation for confident, responsible AI adoption. Tailor training to each role, involve key partners, and use practical delivery methods.
Use microlearning, peer-led training, and vendor resources. Key personas: Marketing, Service Techs, CSRs, Network Managers, IT, and AI Champions.

Chapter 6: Change Management
Effective change management is the bridge between AI strategy and AI success. Assess readiness, build coalitions, manage resistance with empathy, and communicate with clarity.
Remember: Transformation is social before it is digital. Build coalitions, not committees. Treat resistance as feedback.

Your AI Adoption Quick-Start Checklist

- Form your AI leadership team with clear roles and responsibilities
- Define 2-3 specific business problems AI will help solve
- Identify AI capabilities already available in your existing platforms (Calix Cloud, Microsoft 365, etc.)
- Establish basic governance guidelines for AI use
- Launch role-based training starting with early adopters and champions

Remember: Calix Success is your partner every step of the way.

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